Deloitte.

ABAP Adobe Forms

Deloitte Technology Academy (DTA)

Agenda

Topic	Descriptions	Duration
Adobe Forms	Program, Form builder, Tips and Tricks, and Migration	4 hours

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Learning Objectives

By the end of this session, you will be able to:

- Use transaction SFP
- Create and model form interfaces
- Create and model form contexts
- Use Adobe Live Cycle Designer
- Create and design complex forms for printing with the tool Interactive forms
- Integrate forms into ABAP programs

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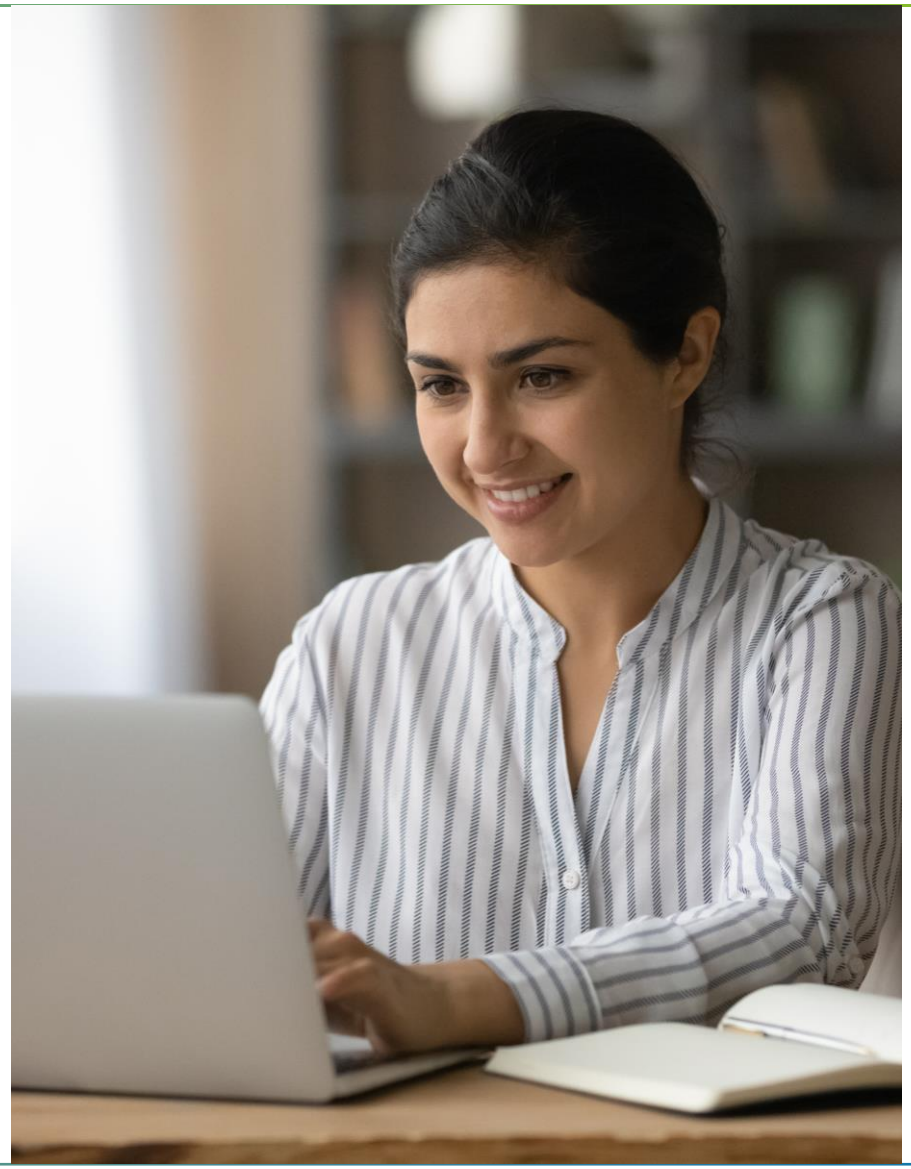
Adobe Forms



Prerequisites for the Workshop

Required:

- BC400 (ABAP workbench: Basics)
- ABAP programming background

Recommended:

- Knowledge of SAPscript and/or smart forms

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Advantages Over Smart Forms/SAPscript

Advantages of Adobe Forms

- PDF is a real standard for forms on the Web
- Adobe LiveCycle Designer is an easy-to-use, flexible tool for designing forms
- Graphics (BMP, JPEG, GIF, PNG, EXIF) can be included in forms directly (no\conversion required)
- Different page orientations (landscape, portrait) are possible within one form
- Existing PDF or Word documents can be imported
- TrueType Fonts can be used; installation requires no upload
- Barcodes can be printed on all printers of types Postscript, PCL, PDF, or Zebra
- Interactive scenarios and integration into browser-based applications are possible (Web Dynpro for Java or ABAP)
- Mailing and faxing is easier
- Forms are regular Repository objects with standard transport and versioning

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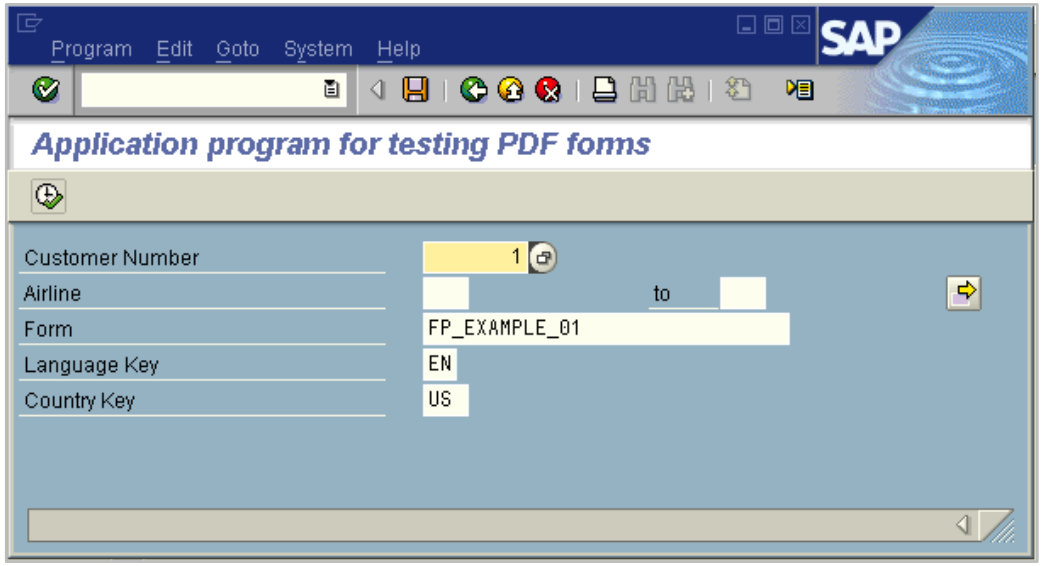
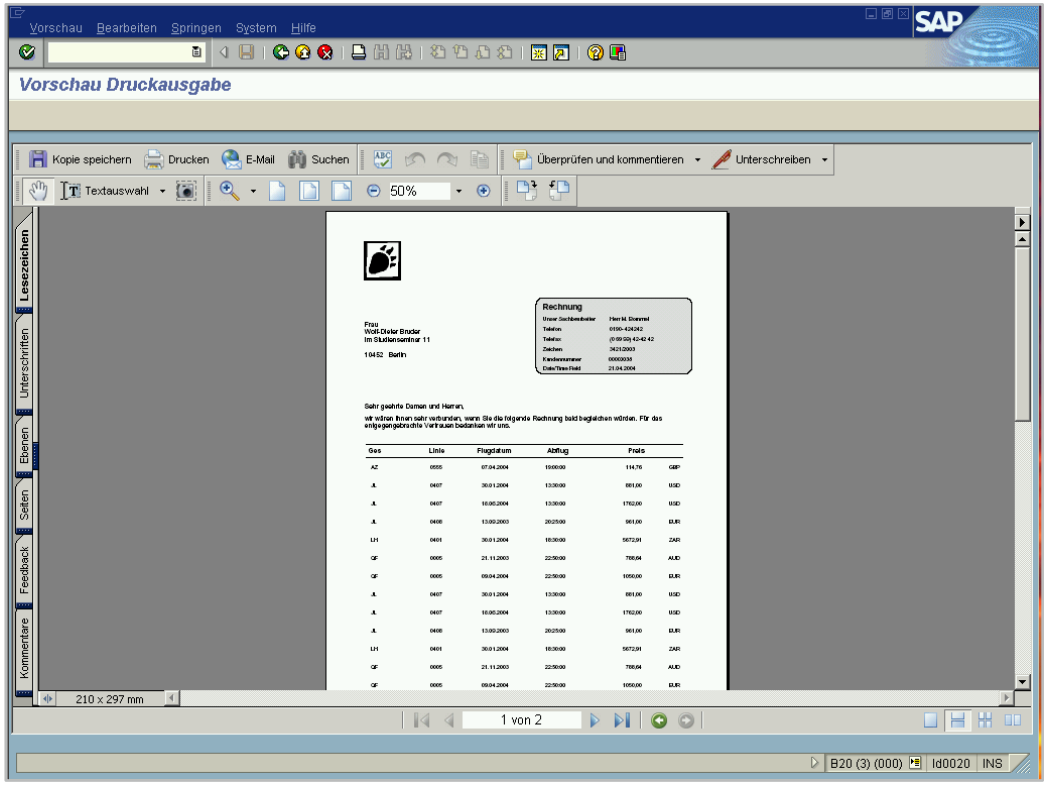
User’s Perspective: Printing With PDF—Based Forms

Program



Resulting Document



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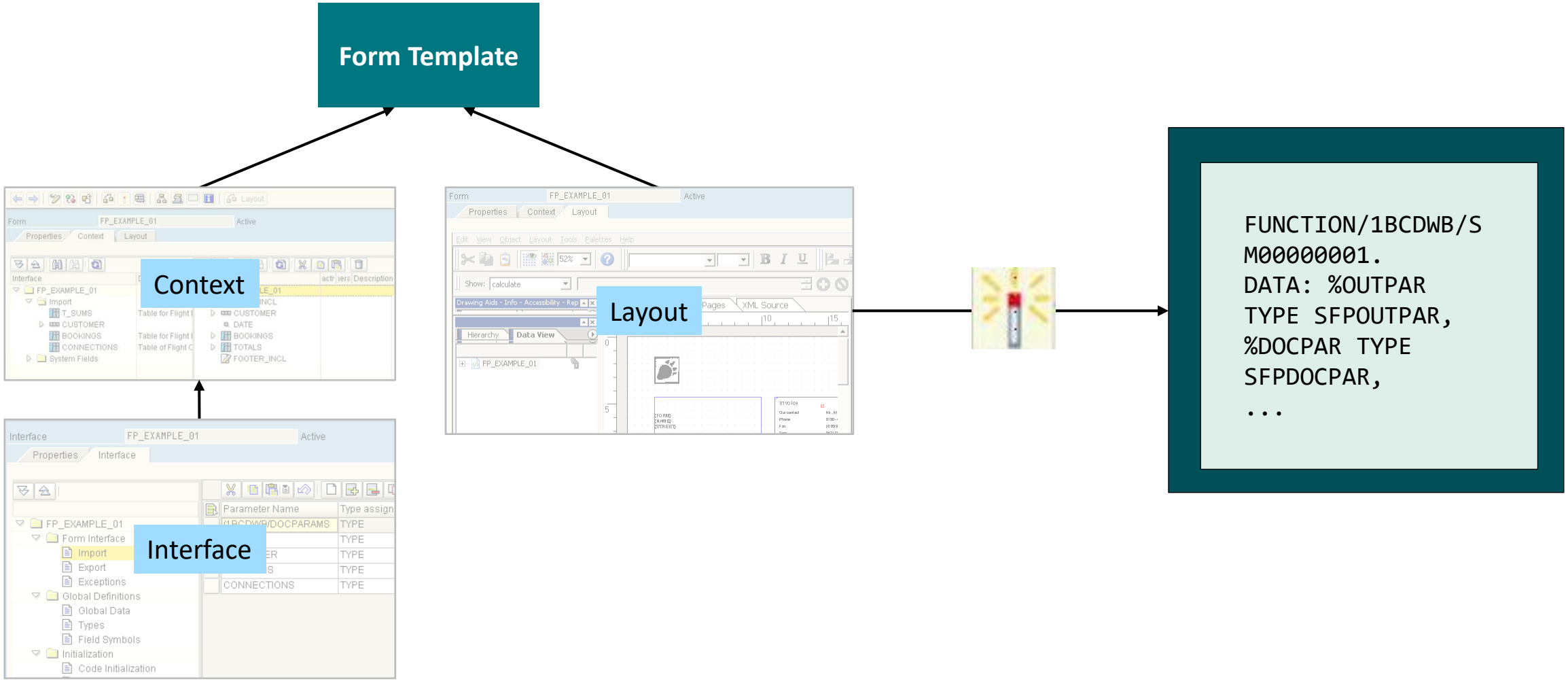
The Tools Involved (Design Time)



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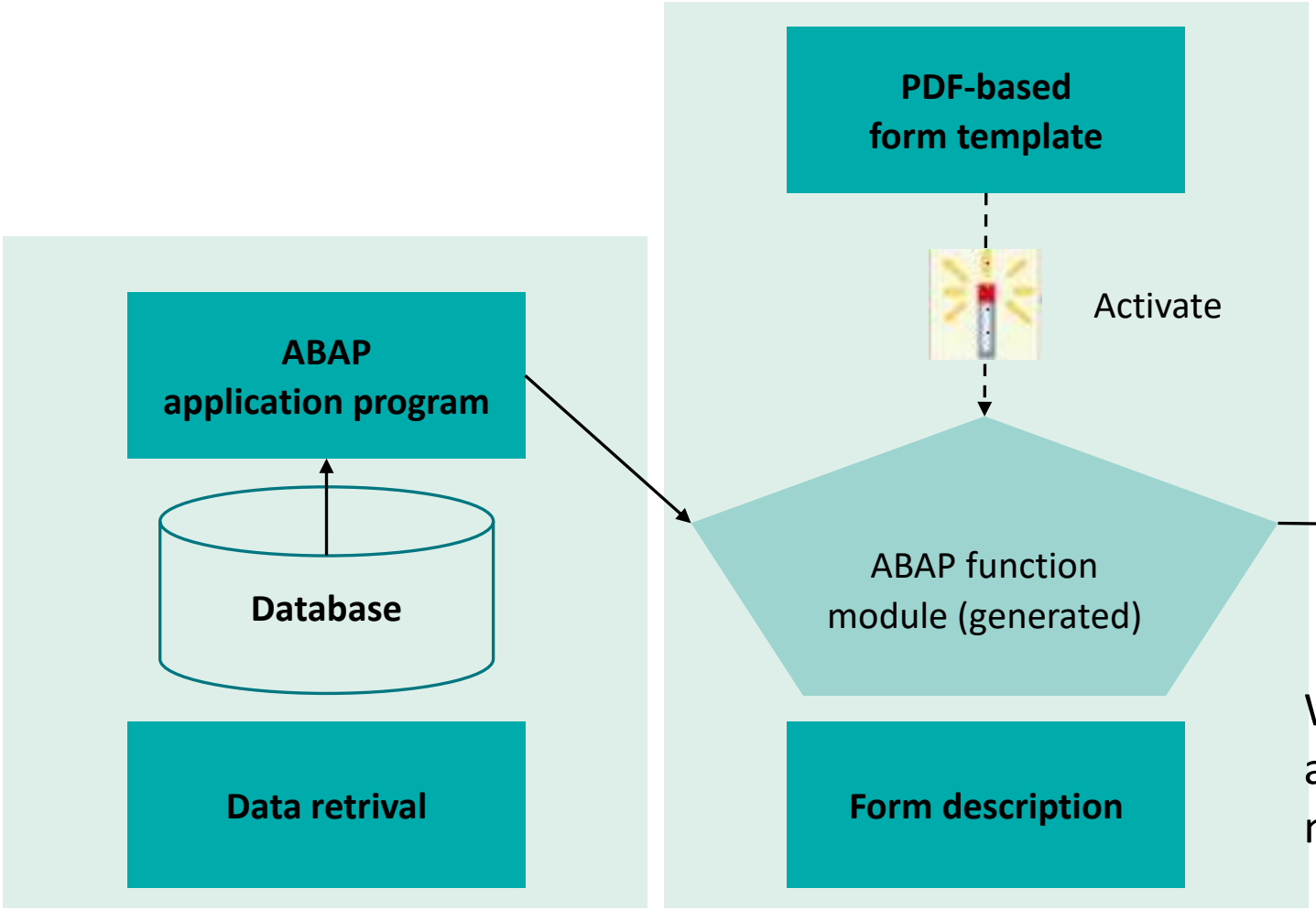
At Runtime



in order to tigger the form you need a driver program and the driver program will call the function module generated.

Printout = Document

When you execute the abap form an abap function
module is generated.

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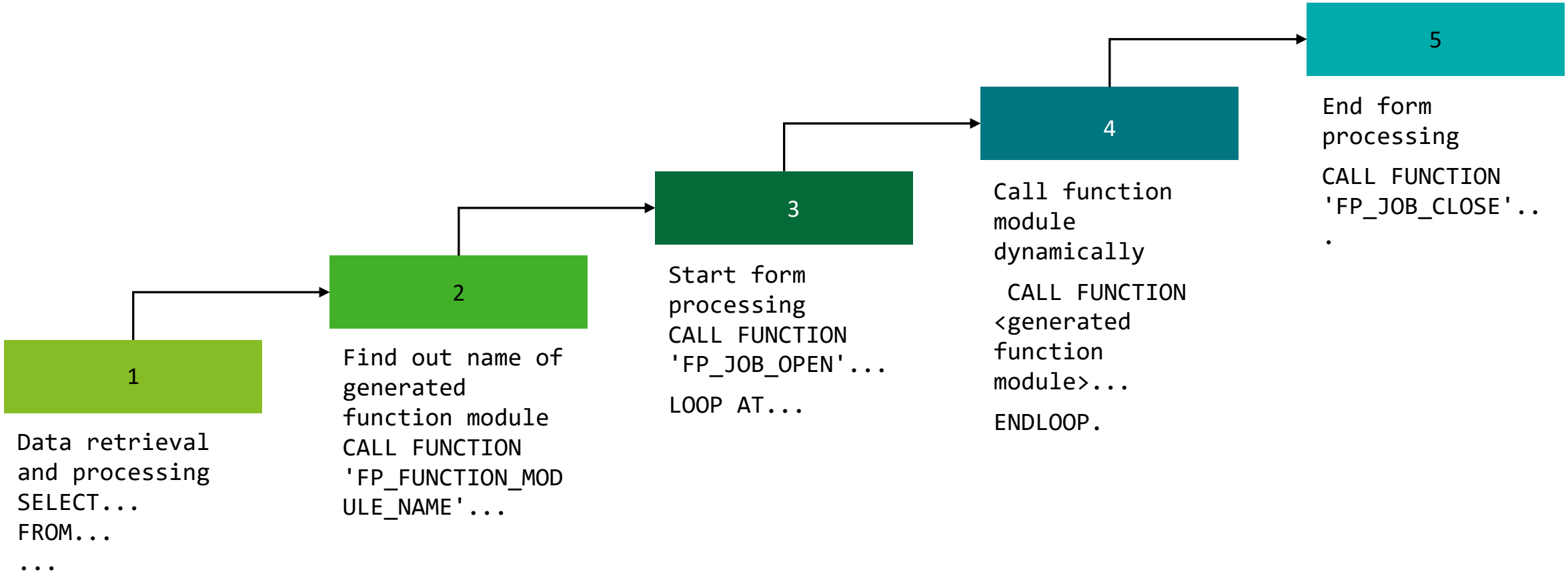
Sections of the Application Program



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Fp_function_module_name

DATA	
form	TYPE fpwbformname
fm_name	TYPE rs38l_fnam
interface_type	TYPE fpinterfacetype

This function basically gives the name of the
runtime generated function module when you give it the form and the interface name.

```
(2) Find out name of generated function module
CALL FUNCTION 'FP_FUNCTION_MODULE_NAME'
EXPORTING i_name                    = form
IMPORTING
            e_funcname   = fm_name
            e_interface_type        = interface_type.
```

```
SELECT NAME?
OPEN
CALL
CLOSE
```


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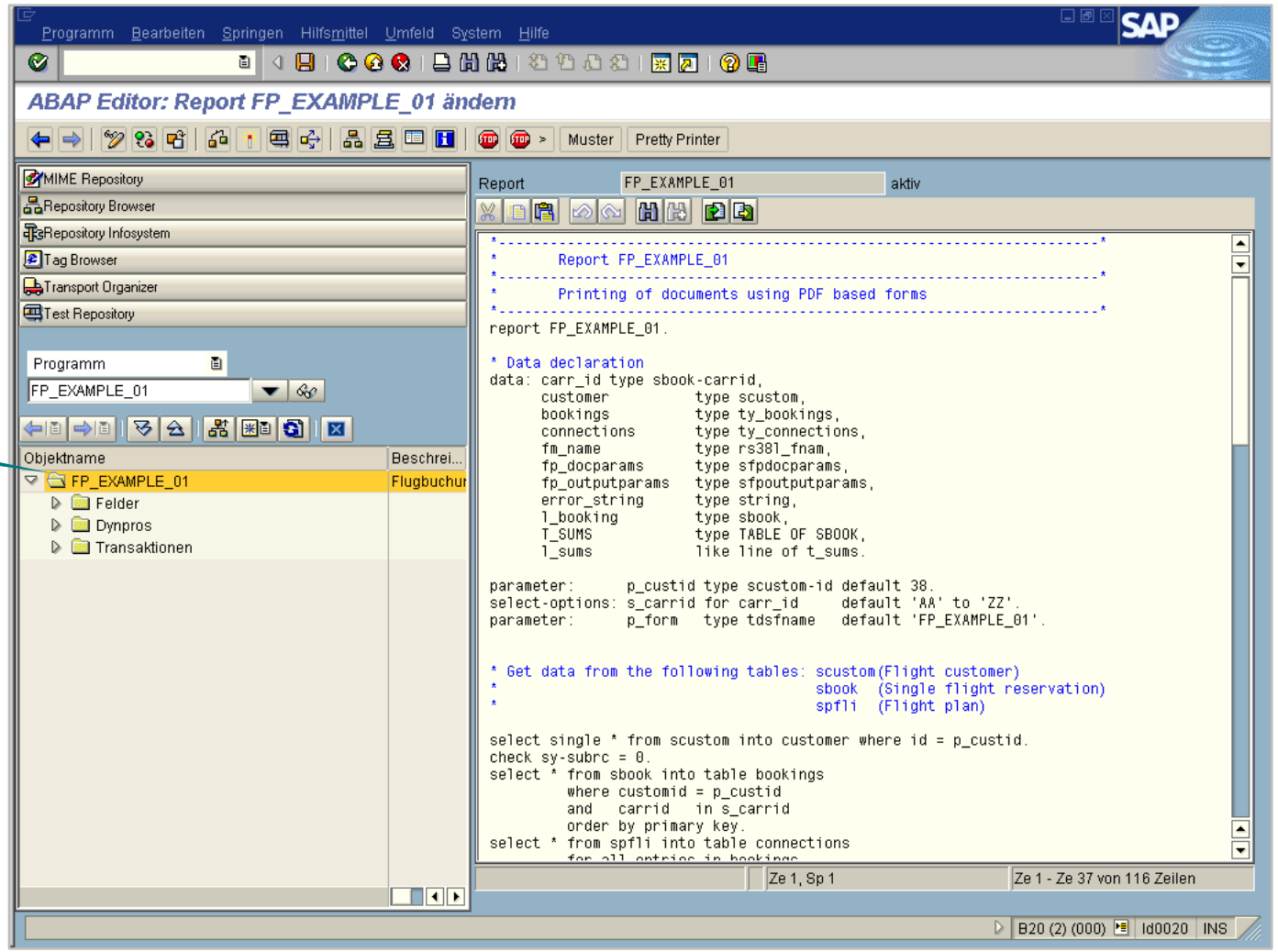
Program—Example Used in Workshop

Program FP_EXAMPLE_01



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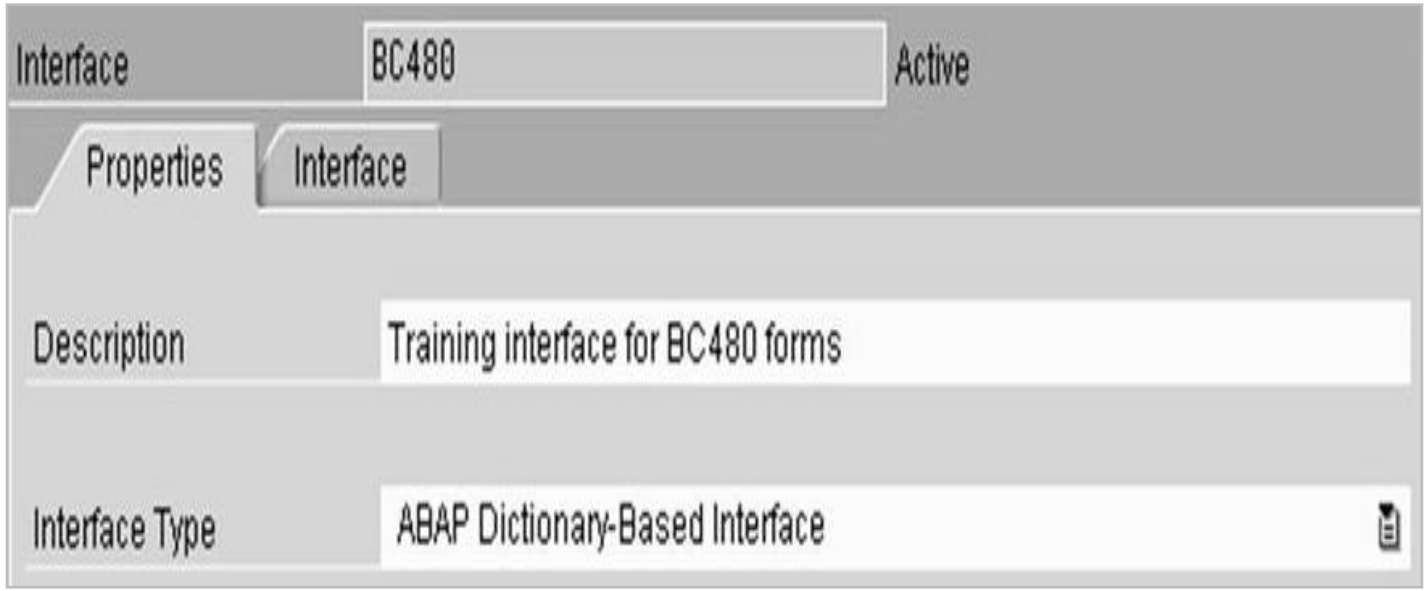
Types of an Interface

ABAP Dictionary-based

Smart Forms Compatible

XML Schema based
(mainly Web Dynpro)



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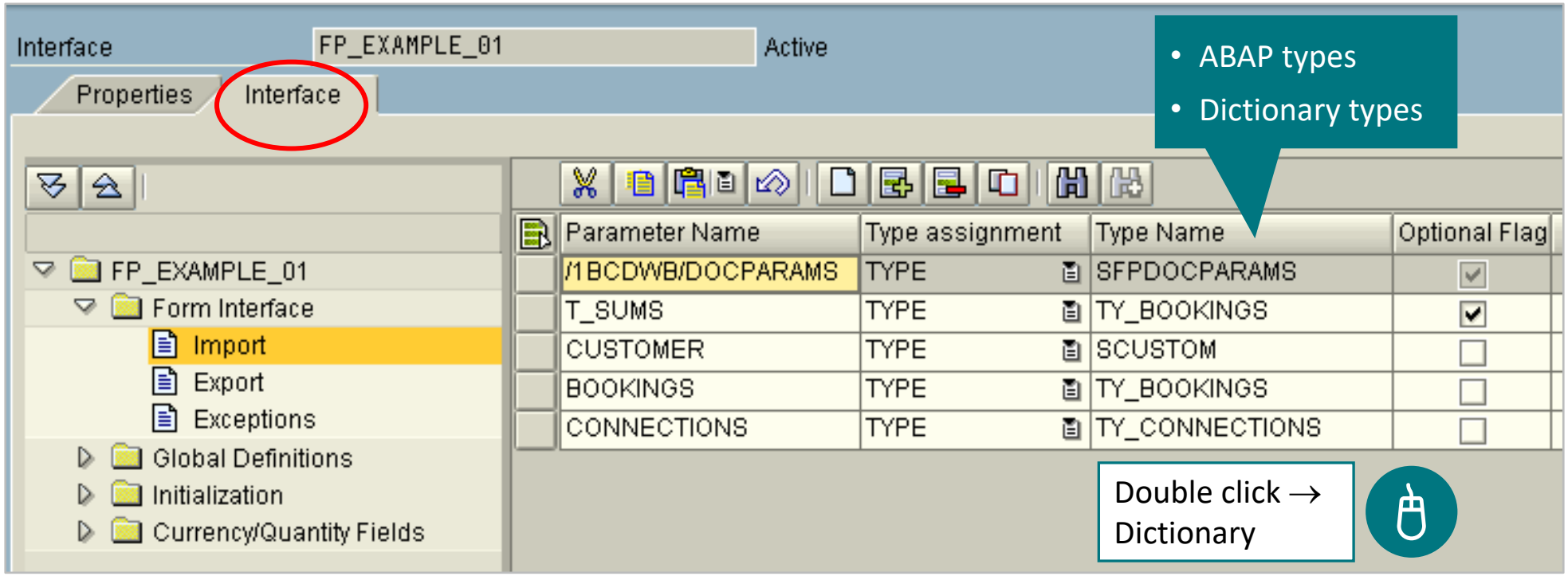
Interface—Form Interface



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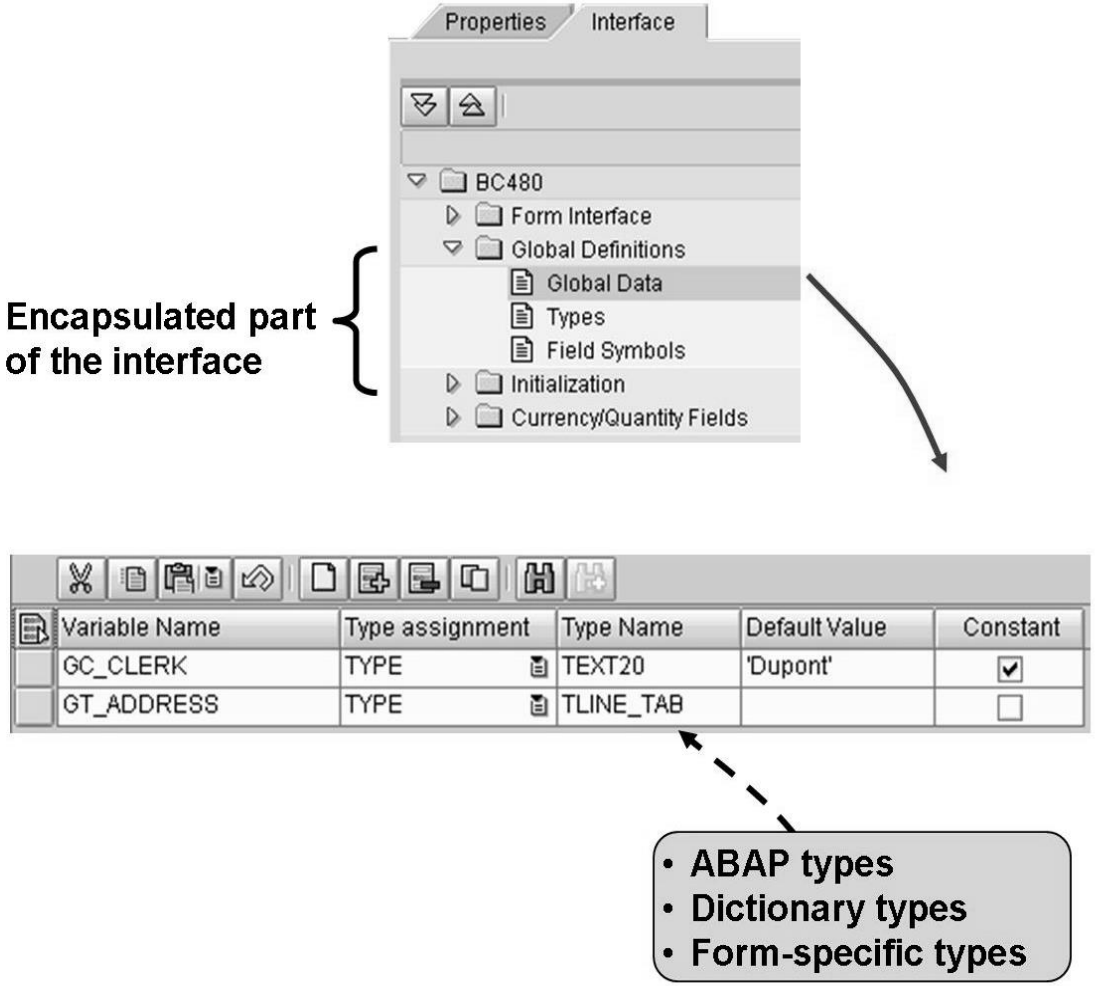
Global Definitions



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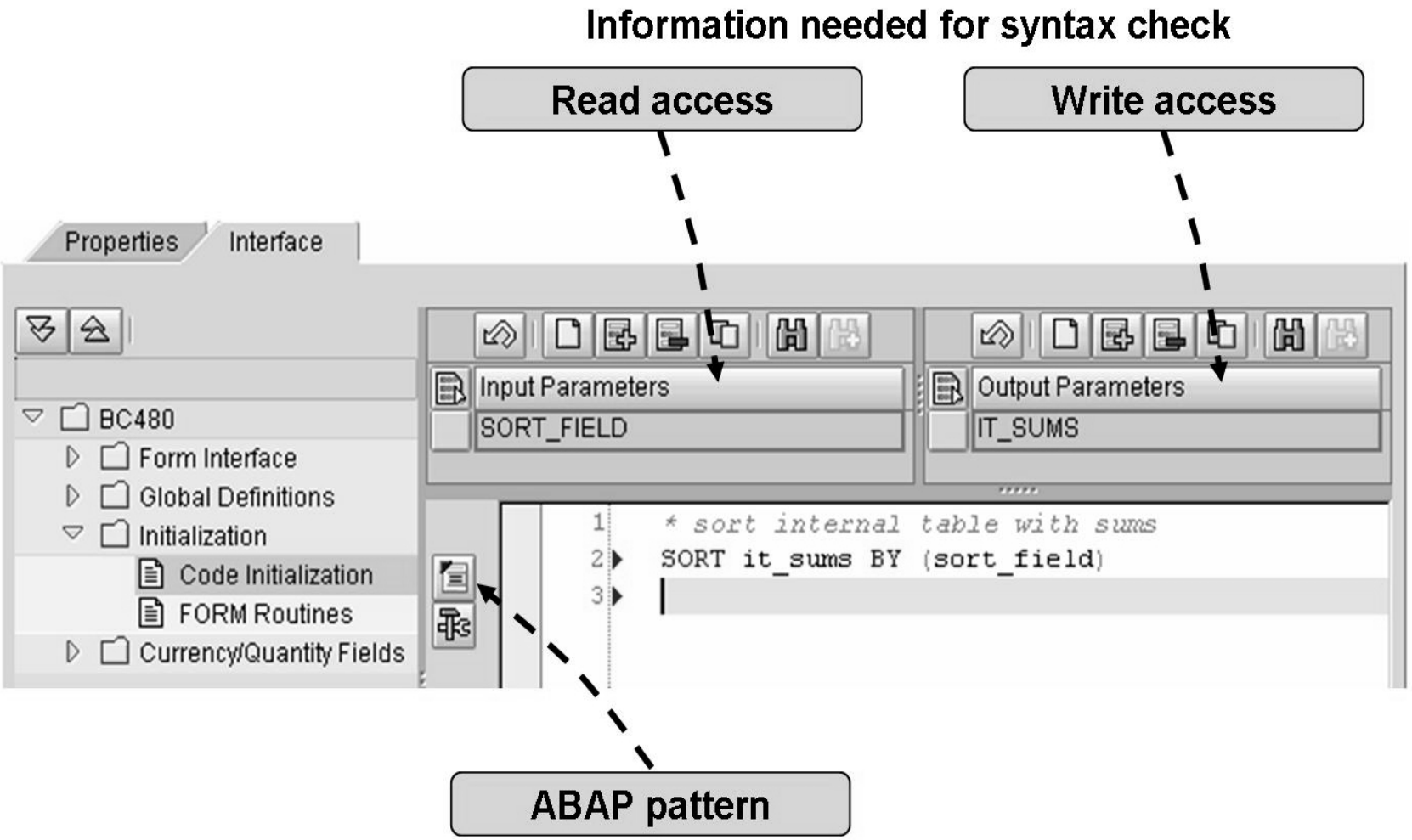
Initialization



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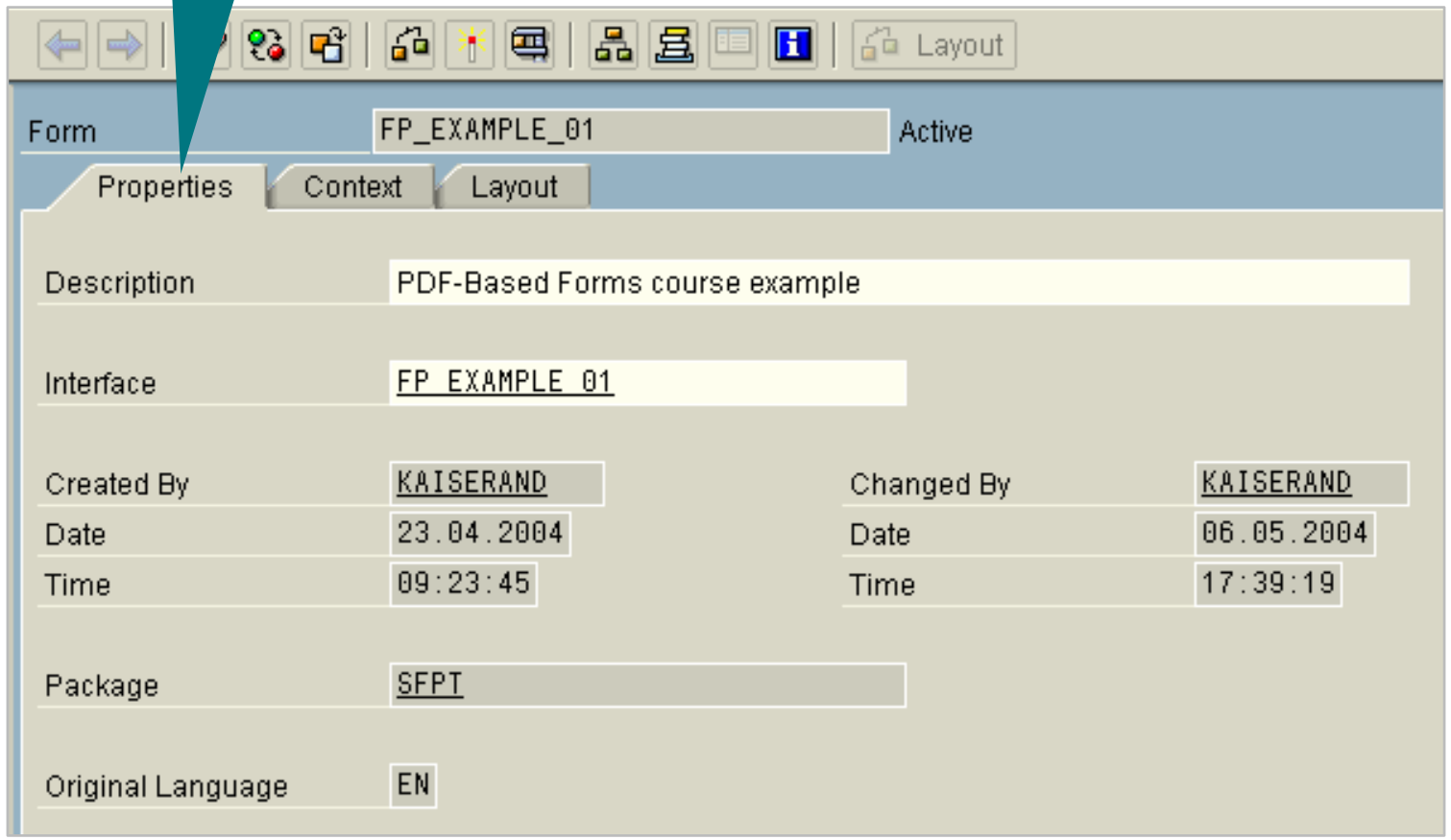
Form Properties

Click Properties



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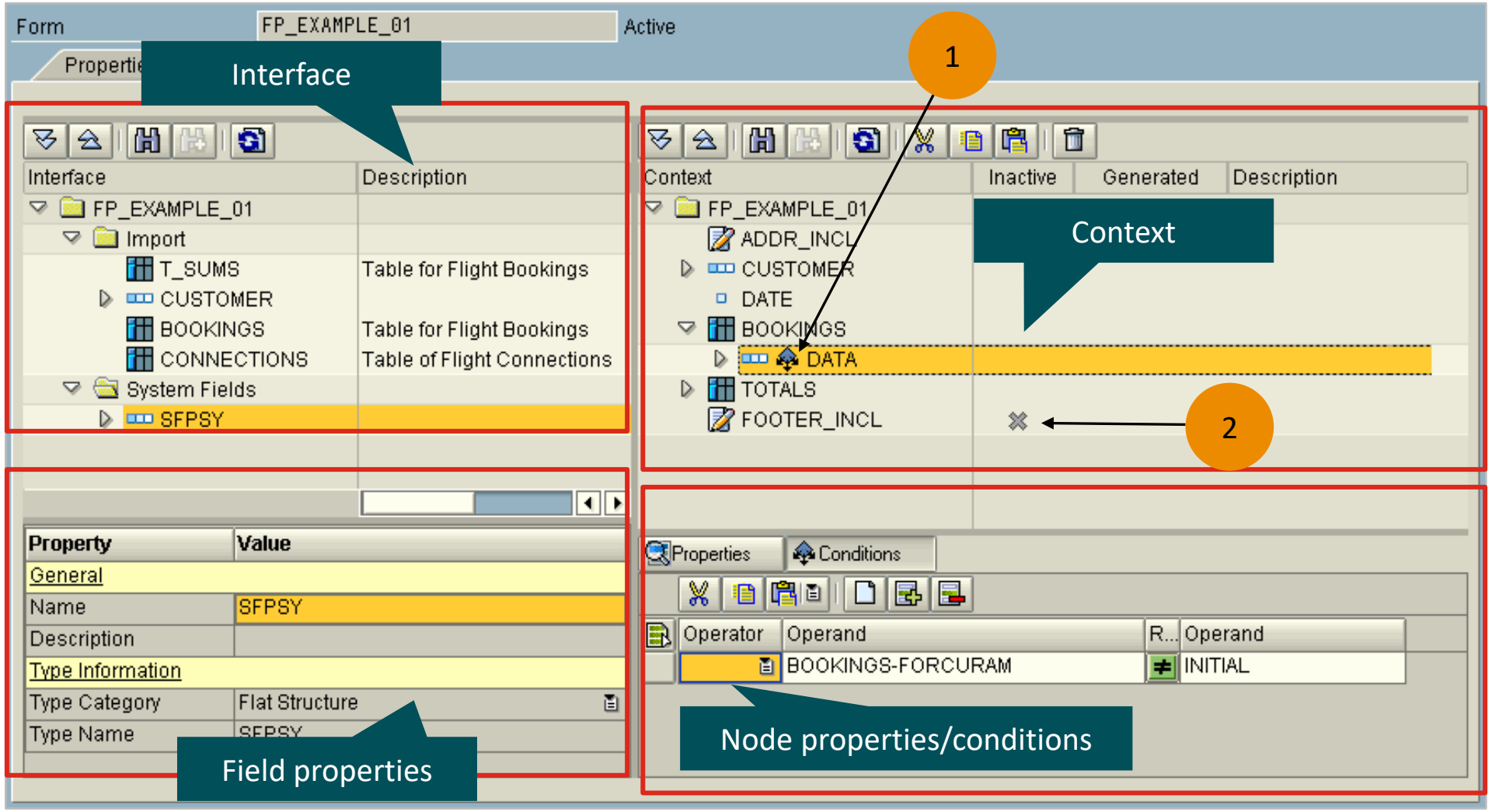
Context—Overview



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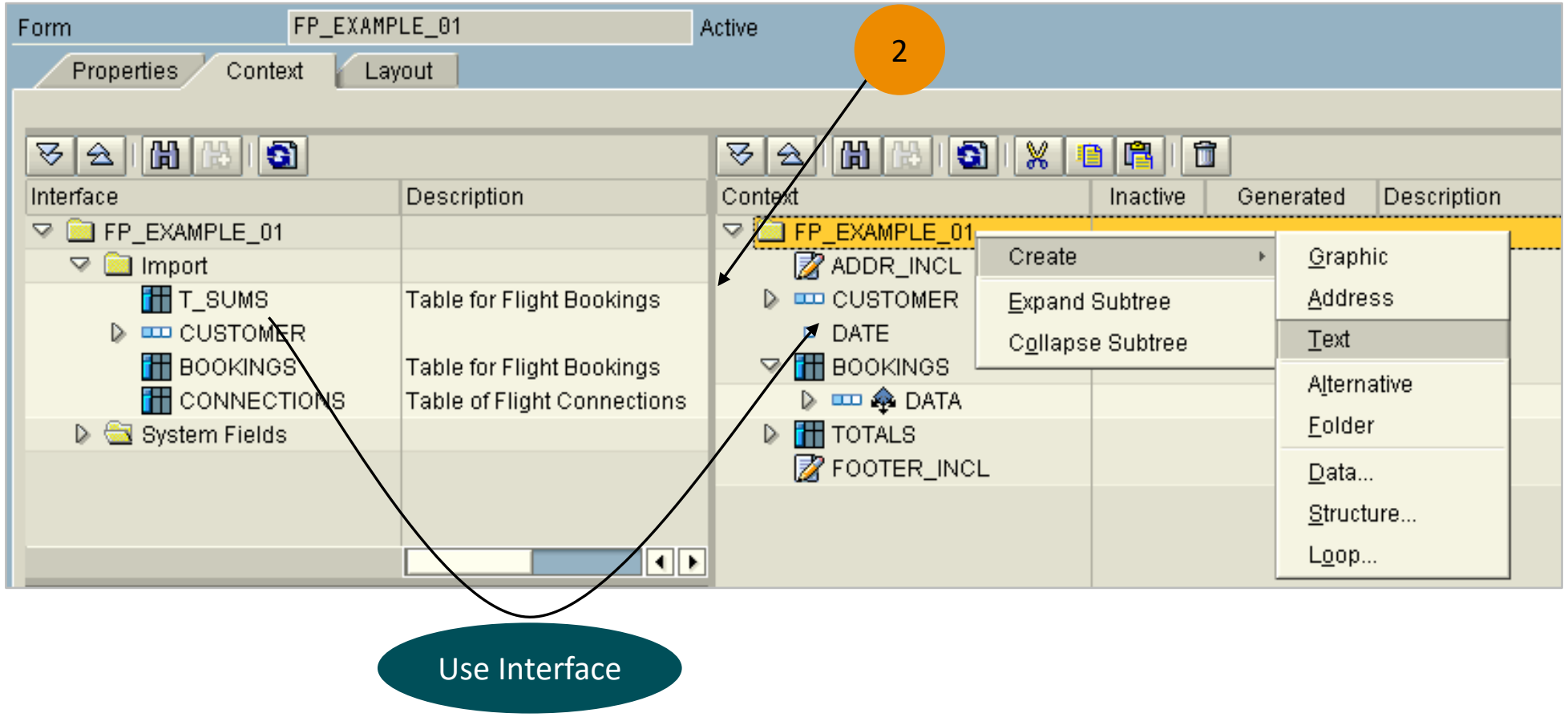
Context—Using the Interface



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Including Addresses

Context	Inactive	Generated	Description
AH_FP_EXAMPLE_01			
ADDRESS			Customer's Address
CUSTOMER			

Address type	• Organization, company • Private address • Contact person (in company) Determine dynamically
Address number	Required for all address types
Person number	Required for address types 2 and 3
Sending country	Required to distinguish between domestic and international addresses

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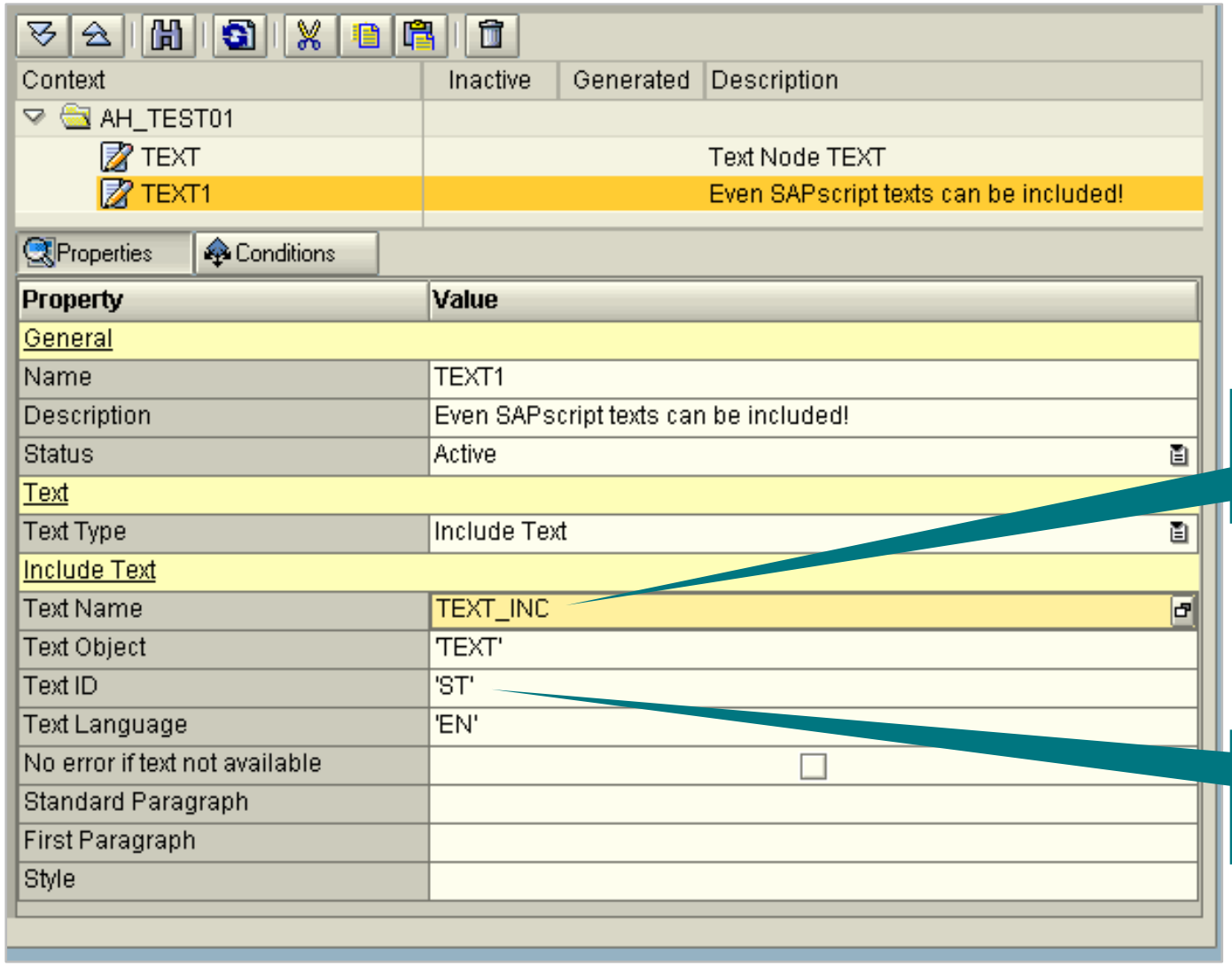
Including SAPscript Texts



Determined at runtime

Determined at design time

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Including Graphics

Type graphic content

Properties | Conditions

Property	Value
General	
Name	LOGO1
Description	Company logo
Status	Active
Graphic	
Graphic Type	Graphic Content
Graphic Content	
Field	G1
MIME Type	'GIF'

Type graphic reference

Properties | URL | Conditions

Property	Value
General	
Name	LOGO1
Description	Company logo
Status	Active
Graphic	
Graphic Type	Graphic Reference

Properties | URL | Conditions

Graphic URL	Delimiter
'http://www.sap.com/GLOBAL/IMAGES'	/
URL	

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Designer—Technical Prerequisites

- SAP GUI for Windows
  - A 6.40 GUI: make sure that the designer is installed and check on your hard drive
  - Default location: C:\Program Files\Adobe\Designer 7.0 or above

Adobe reader 7.0 (used to be acrobat reader) or above

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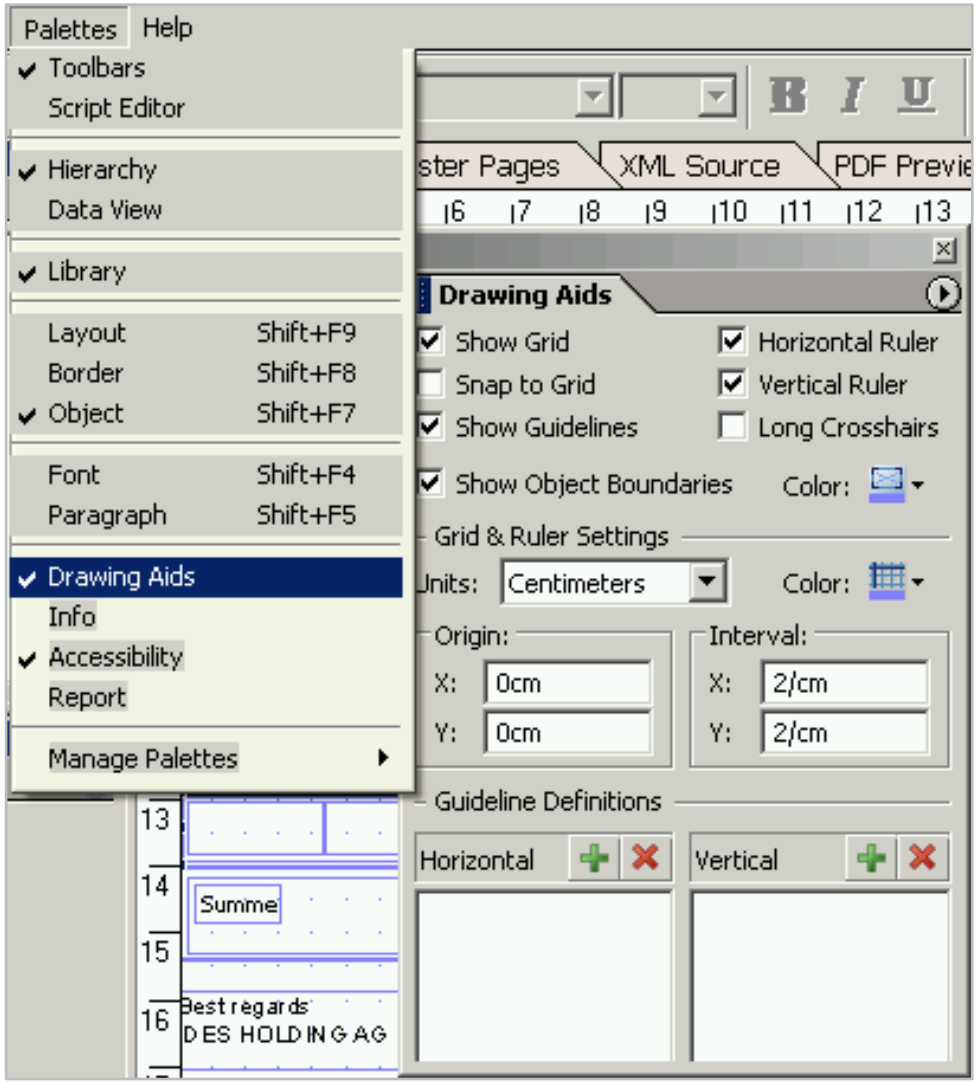
Drawing Aids—Settings for the Layout Editor



Before you start with a new form determine the basic settings for the Layout Editor in Palettes → Drawing Aids

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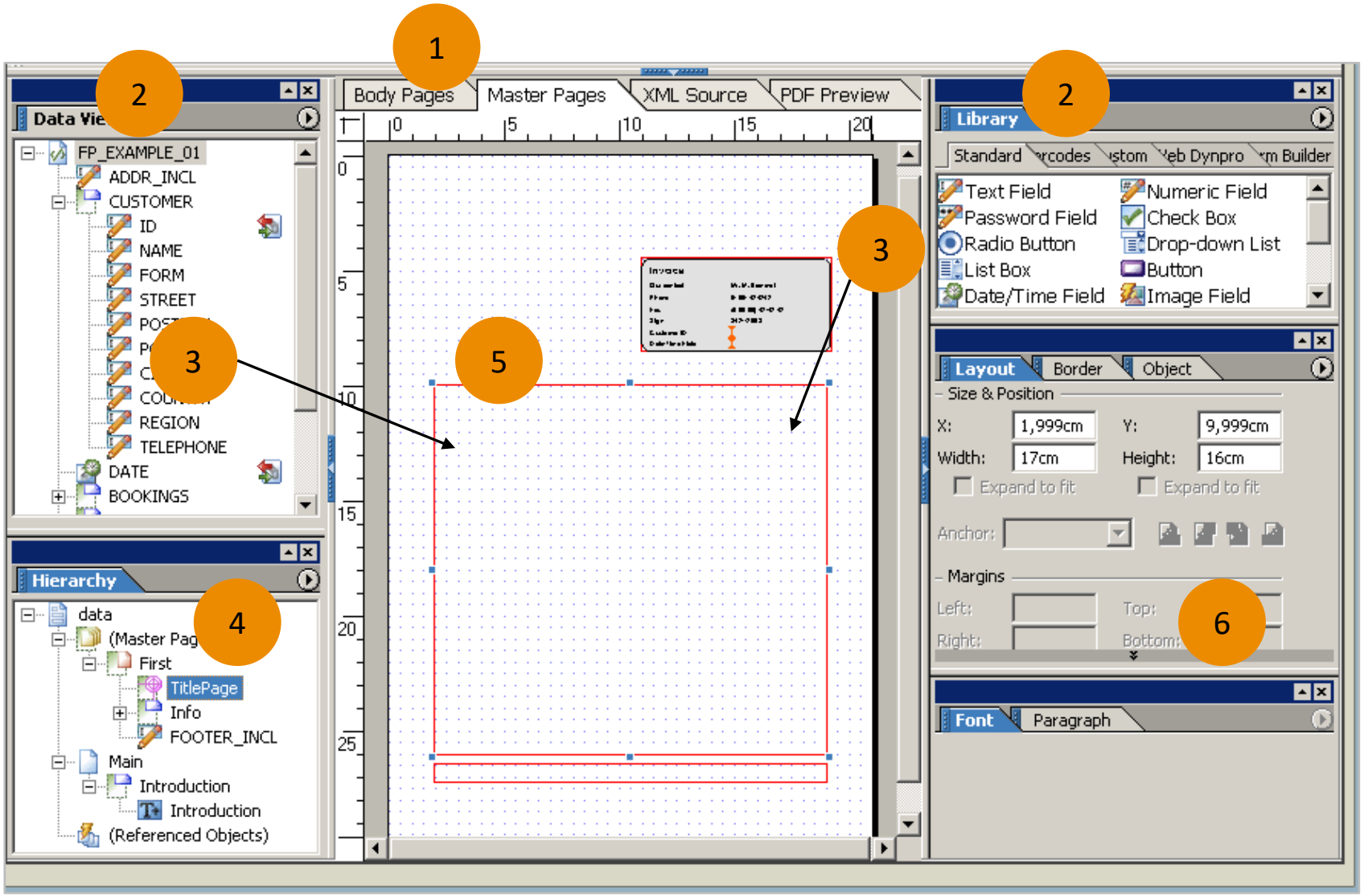
The Layout Editor—Including Objects



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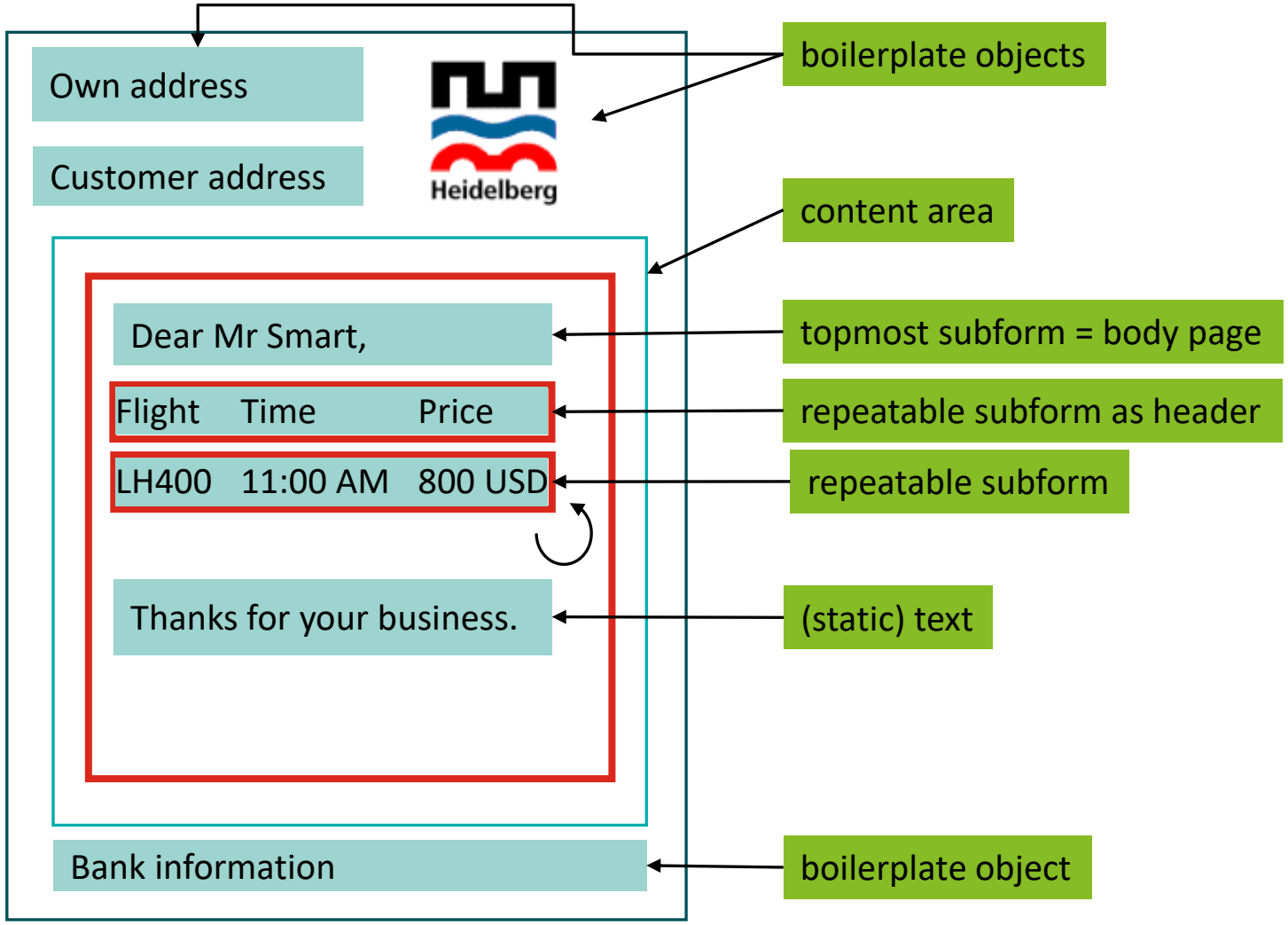
Objects on a Master Page



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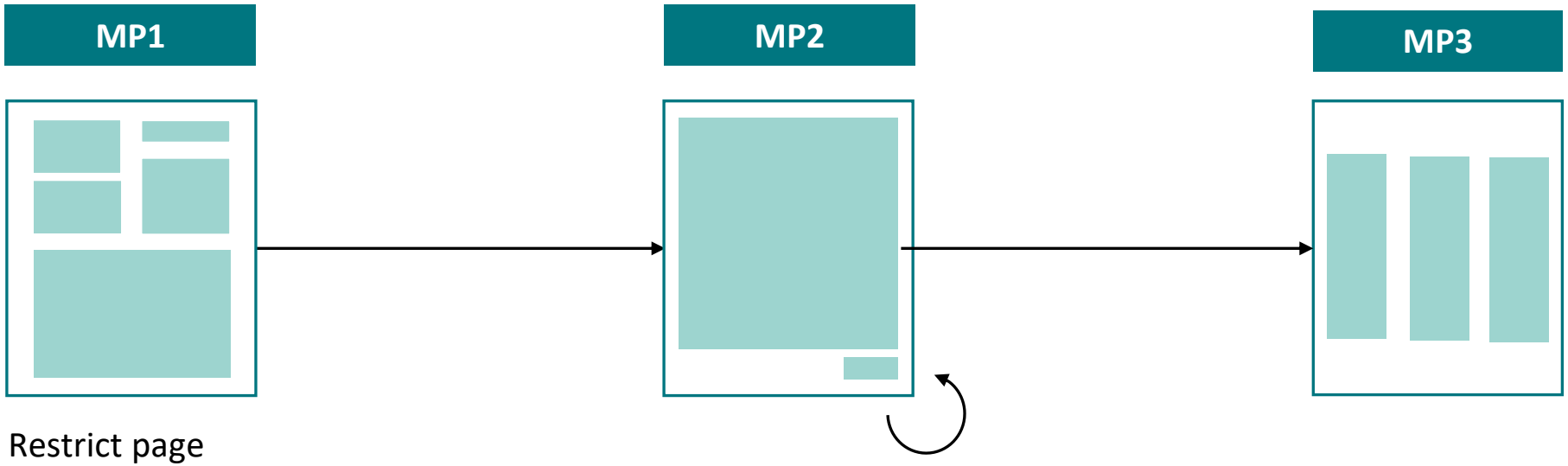
Inserting Several Master Pages



Restrict page occurrence:
max count = 1

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What Are Subforms?

Can be laid down only in the content area of a master page.

If of type position content, objects of subforms can be laid down at their exact position at runtime (Hierarchy position of objects not relevant for layout position).

If of type flow content, the objects will follow each other, depending on which space they require at runtime.

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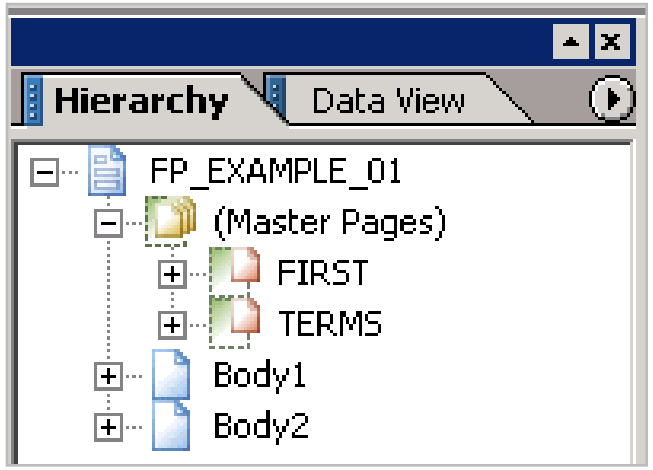
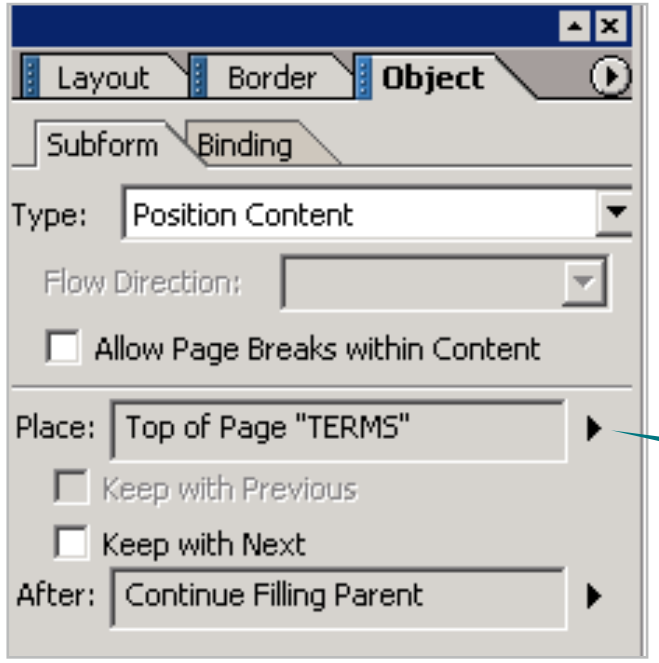
What Are Body Pages and When to Include Them?

When should you insert a new body page?

- When you want to make clear that a new page starts here (make sure to say so!)
- When you want to make sure you want to lay down a subform on a particular master page.





Alternative:
Top of next page

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Scripting

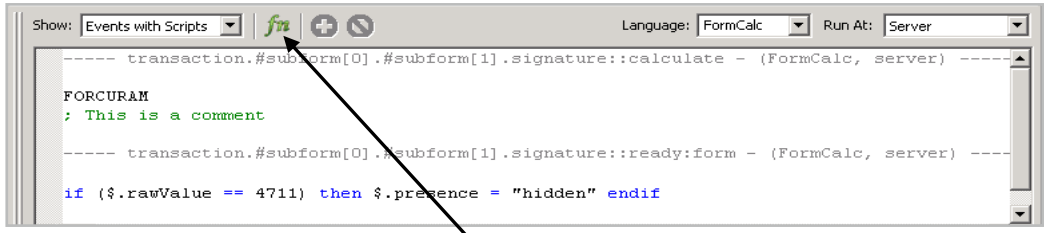
Single-line display

- FormCalc (recommended for print forms)
- JavaScript (recommended for interactive forms)

various events

- Client
- Server

Multi-line display



option available in multi-line display only

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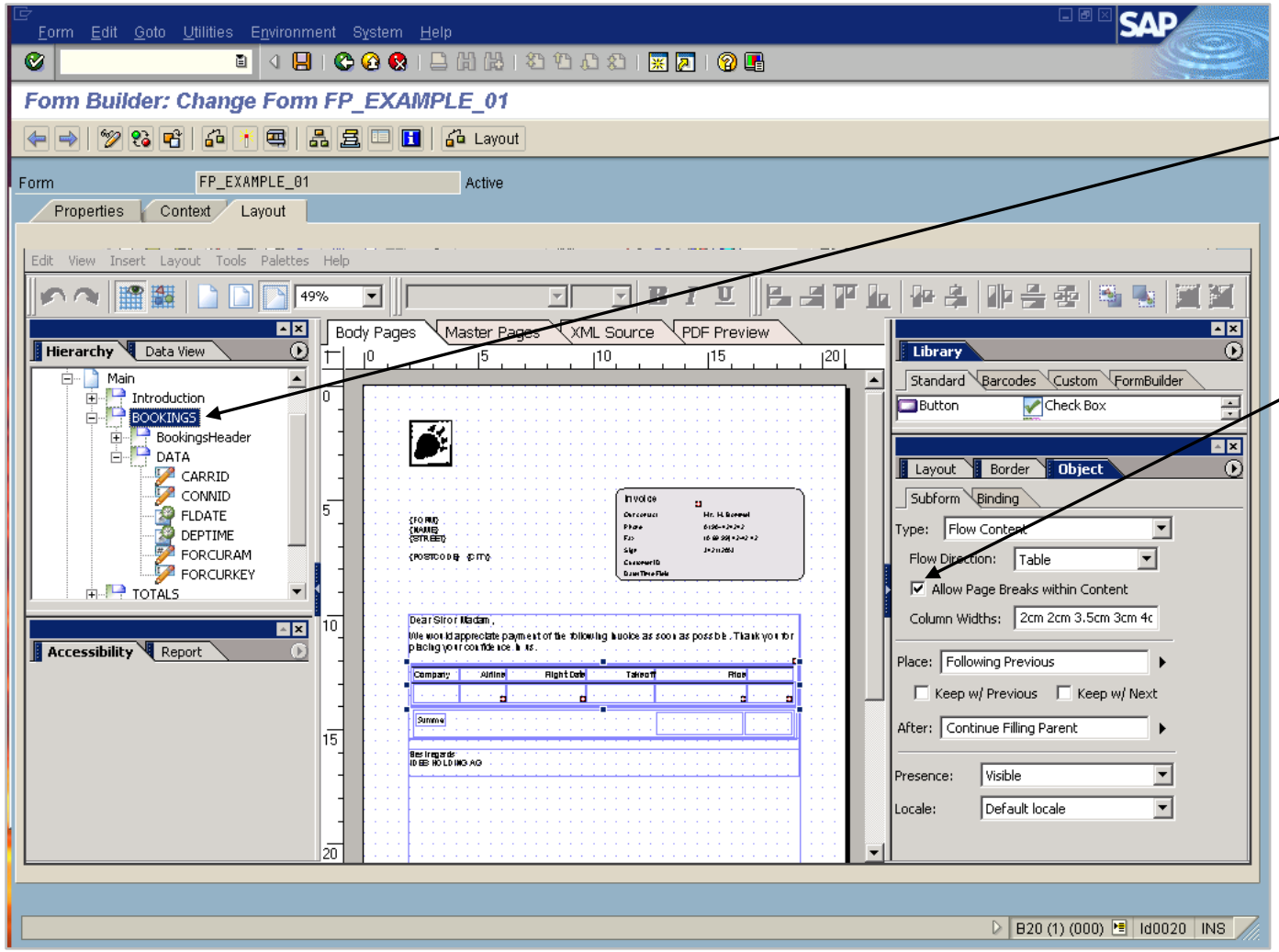
Protect (Controlling Page Breaks)



To control content page breaks, choose Palette Object → Subform → Allow Page Break within Content.

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Suggested Approach to Designing Forms

Take the time to review the data schema (i. e. the context).
• Compare the flow of the data to the physical output of the form.
• Ideally, the data flow should have logical groups that match the logical groupings of the physical file.
• Ensure that the data schema has a data node that is representative of one transaction/form.
• The data view in the designer is a good tool for determining the grouping.
• Draw the form initially without subforms or with only a few subforms to start.
• To replicate objects, choose copy/duplicate multiple.
• If a field is not behaving as expected, try recreating it.
• For print forms, margins may not be required.
• Save the form frequently and incrementally if possible.
• Place the items/fields on the form in the order they appear on the printout and in the order in which they appear on the form.
• After creating your subforms and before setting their properties, test whether that data is still populating.
• Before setting the page content area to Flowed, set your layout information for each subform.

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Suggested Approach to Designing Forms (Cont.)

The last step(s) you should take is/are
• Creating any reference/overflow items
• Setting page content to flowed

Check?

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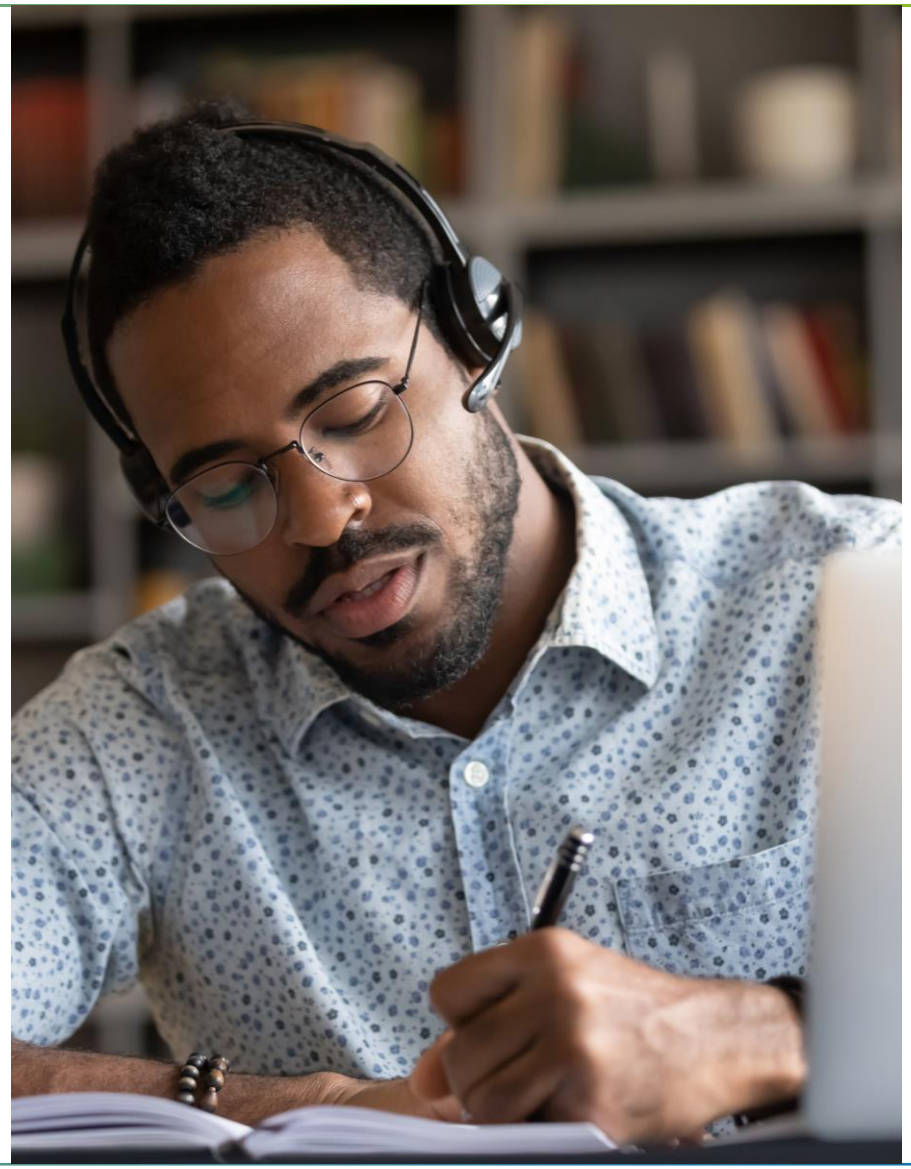
Hands-On Labs



Hands-On Activity 1

Activity Details	
Problem Statement	Perform the exercises in the ABAP Adobe Forms: Exercises document

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Summary

Here are the key learning points of the module.

- To access the Form Builder use transaction SFP.
- By double clicking on one of the nodes in the interface tree on the left-hand side of the screen, an area opens up in the right-hand side that lets you enter the details. The part that is between program and form is the form interface.
- The screen is split into two halves on the tab strip Context. The context side contains those fields that are available in the layout. These fields are a subset of the interface.
- What you set as the unit for grid and ruler will also be taken for the positioning and sizing of objects.
- Every form design contains at least one master page that Designer creates automatically.

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